



AI Shopping Research Platform

High-Fidelity Telemetry, Counter-Balancing, & Live Analytics

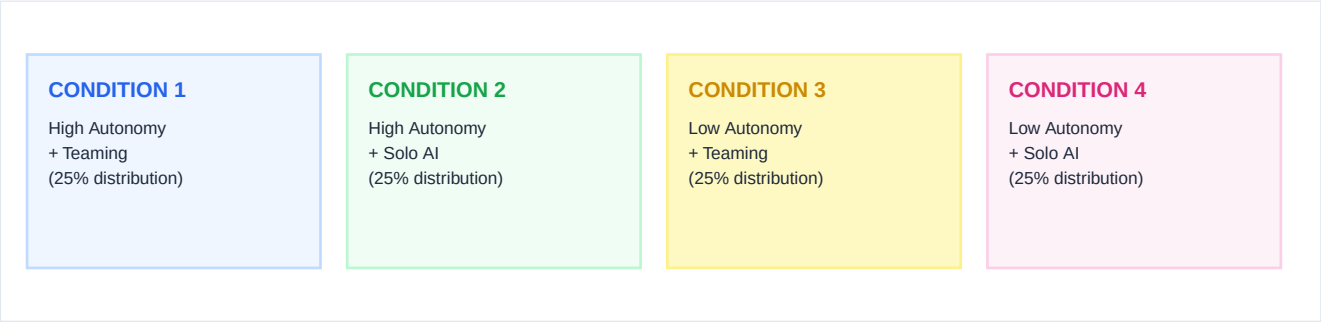
A premium social computing research system testing AI shopping assistant autonomy, user trust, and multi-agent collaborative teaming interfaces. Featuring exact counterbalanced group assignment and real-time Knack database behavioral tracking.

SYSTEM ENVIRONMENT & TELEMETRY

Primary Database:	Knack Cloud DB (Table 1 / object_3)
Integration Protocol:	JSON Telemetry Serialization via REST API
Client Architecture:	Expo React Native + Web Optimizations

1. Direct-Entry Architecture & Participant Flow

The platform is configured to direct participants instantly to the AI shopping assistant session. Instead of manual study selection, opening the application automatically generates a unique session ID, counterbalances the participant into one of the four experimental conditions at a 25/25/25/25 ratio, and redirects directly to the chat interface.



Portal Features

- Real-time Counterbalance Routing: Opening the application automatically triggers the counterbalance checks, guaranteeing that participant counts across the 4 conditions stay exactly balanced (25:25:25:25).
- Suggested Task Prompt: The chat interface displays a premium clickable Suggested Task chip containing the standard prompt. Tapping it submits it instantly, eliminating human keyboard entry error.
- Wallet Reset Telemetry: When starting a session, the user's wallet balance automatically resets to \$1,002.00, and previous local chat histories are wiped clean to prevent carry-over effects.

2. Round-Robin Randomization Algorithm

To guarantee exact statistical cell parity (25/25/25/25 across the 4 conditions), the application implements a round-robin counterbalance algorithm in `src/services/randomizationService.ts`. Instead of simple `math-random` (which leads to highly unequal groups at small sample sizes), the system follows a deterministic assignment queue:

```
ALGORITHM FLOW SPECIFICATION (TypeScript)

// 1. Fetch historical counts from persistent memory
const counts = JSON.parse(localStorage.getItem('study2_counter') || '{"S2_HL":0,"S2_HH":0,"S2_LL":0,"S2_LH":0}');

// 2. Identify the scenario candidates with the minimum count
const minCount = Math.min(counts.S2_HL, counts.S2_HH, counts.S2_LL, counts.S2_LH);
const candidates = ['S2_HL', 'S2_HH', 'S2_LL', 'S2_LH'].filter(s => counts[s] === minCount);

// 3. Assign user, increment cell, and lock assignment in persistent session
const assigned = candidates[Math.floor(Math.random() * candidates.length)];
counts[assigned]++;
localStorage.setItem('study2_counter', JSON.stringify(counts));
```

3. Structured Telemetry & Logging Protocol

To maintain compatibility with standard Knack fields, all tracking data is compiled into a high-fidelity JSON payload and stored in Table 1 (object_3), field_23 (Name). This enables complete behavioral tracking of clicks, timing, and purchasing decisions.

Event Classification & Payloads

Event Type	Description	Key Telemetry Fields Tracked
ASSIGNED	Fires on study enter.	study, scenario, autonomyLevel, teaming, description
MESSAGE_SENT	Fires on user text chat.	text, charCount, wordCount, timestamp
MESSAGE_RECEIVED	AI response delivery.	aiMessage, actionType, matchedProductId, matchedPrice
DECISION_ACTION	Final transaction state.	action (CONFIRMED DECLINED AUTO_PURCHASED GUARD_BLOCKED), price, walletAfter

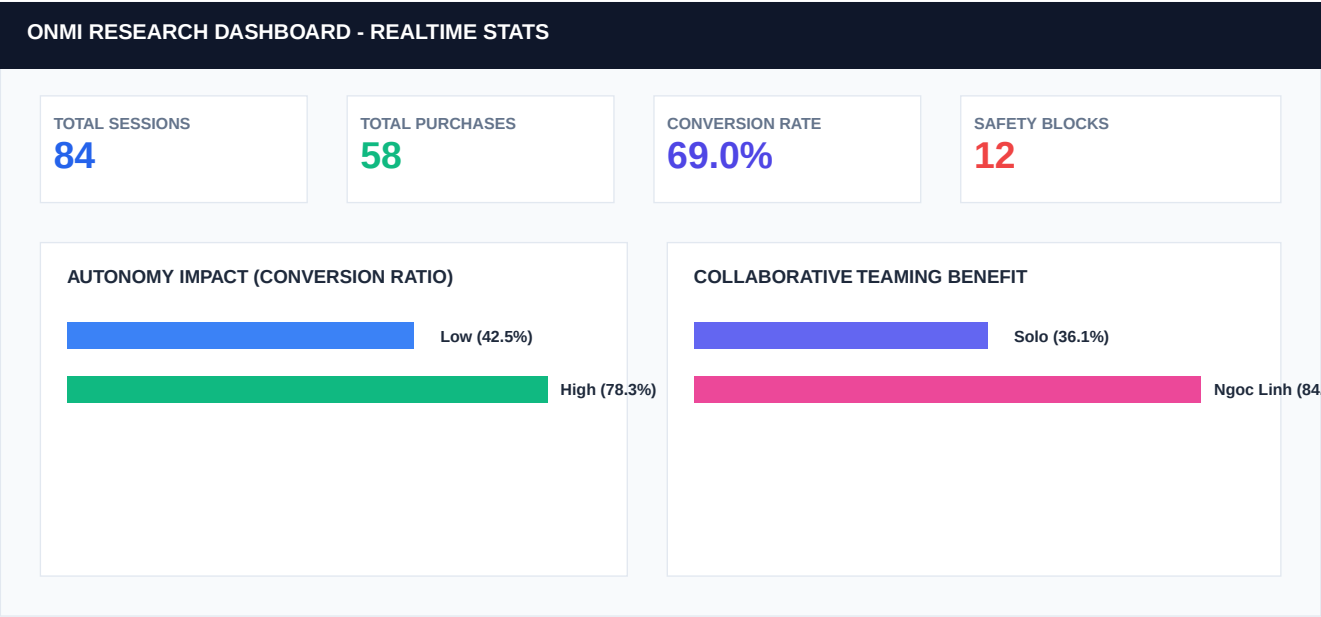
4. Analytical Advantages

By standardizing all actions around a persistent Session ID (e.g. sess_1703112000_a1b2c3d4), researchers gain tremendous advantages during analysis:

- Timeline Reconstruction: Easily order actions chronologically to trace the exact dialog history and decision milestones for each respondent.
- Conversion Funnel Modeling: Measure drop-offs, refusal counts (Alternative Request), and purchase rates based on varying autonomy levels.
- Safety Intercept Analysis: Track how safety budget guard limits prevent High Autonomy agent checkout, showing the limits of agency.

5. Live Analytics & Research Dashboard Guide

A full-featured analytics suite is built directly into the client at /dashboard. It fetches live, raw telemetry from the Knack database and aggregates them instantly into visual indicators and inspectable tables.



Operations & Exporting Instructions

1. Live Refresh: Click the indigo "Refresh" button at the top-right to pull current logs from the Knack REST API instantly. The loading spinner will indicate network progress.
2. Respondent Analysis Grid: The bottom half of the dashboard shows all active sessions. Clicking a row dynamically populates the step-by-step chat history panel on the right.
3. CSV Exporting: Click "Export CSV" to immediately trigger a browser file download of the full, flattened data structure. The system parses the JSON column and compiles it into a clean, comma-delimited Excel-compatible format.

6. Experimental Conditions & Simulation Flow

The platform evaluates four experimental conditions crossing AI autonomy with human-AI teaming. The following models the agent response templates, matched criteria, and wallet deduction telemetry for each condition:

COND 1: HIGH AUTONOMY + TEAMING AI Response Message Template: Based on your request, the AI agent analyzed the available options and selected the best match: a versatile brown jacket in size M for \$47.90. Ngoc Linh, your human shopping agent, also reviewed the choice and confirmed that it perfectly fits your request and stays under your \$50 budget. Since both the AI agent and Ngoc Linh confirmed it as a perfect match, the purchase has been completed automatically using your wallet balance. Match Reasons: • Comfort Brown color • Size M • Within budget • Reviewed by Ngoc Linh System Action & Telemetry: <i>Purchase completed automatically by AI with human-agent review.</i> <i>New balance updated to \$954.10.</i>	COND 2: HIGH AUTONOMY + SOLO AI AI Response Message Template: Based on your request, the AI agent analyzed the available options and selected the best match: a versatile brown jacket in size M for \$47.90. Since it perfectly matches your request and stays under your \$50 budget, the purchase has been completed automatically using your wallet balance. Match Reasons: • Comfort Brown color • Size M • Within budget System Action & Telemetry: <i>Purchase completed automatically by AI. New balance updated to \$954.10.</i>
COND 3: LOW AUTONOMY + TEAMING AI Response Message Template: Based on your request, the AI agent analyzed the available options and found a strong match: a versatile brown jacket in size M for \$47.90. Ngoc Linh, your human shopping agent, also reviewed the recommendation and confirmed that it fits your request and stays under your \$50 budget. Since the system does not complete purchases without your approval, please confirm whether you would like to proceed with payment. Match Reasons: • Comfort Brown color • Size M • Within budget • Reviewed by Ngoc Linh System Action & Telemetry: <i>User confirmation needed. Your wallet balance will be updated to \$954.10 only if you approve the purchase.</i>	COND 4: LOW AUTONOMY + SOLO AI AI Response Message Template: Based on your request, the AI agent analyzed the available options and found a recommended match: a versatile brown jacket in size M for \$47.90. It matches your preferred color, size, usual style, and budget. Since the system does not complete purchases without your approval, please confirm whether you would like to purchase this item. Match Reasons: • Comfort Brown color • Size M • Within budget System Action & Telemetry: <i>User confirmation needed. Your wallet balance will be updated to \$954.10 only if you approve the purchase.</i>

